

STATEMENTS OF PROSECUTION WITNESSES

Extracts of key depositions for case analysis

CW-1 — Shri Pradeep K. Menon (Chief Manager, Bank of Hindustan)

Statement u/s 161 CrPC recorded on 20-Jan-2026

I am the Chief Manager at the Zonal Office, Connaught Place. During the concurrent audit of BO Ansal Plaza for the period Oct–Dec 2025, the auditors reported that collateral for 22 loan accounts was not traceable in the branch records. I ordered a physical verification, which revealed that the strong room contained no pledged jewellery corresponding to the 13 gold loan accounts, and the locker inventory was unsigned. The loan files contained sanction memos without the requisite committee approvals. I caused a preliminary inquiry to be conducted, which confirmed the irregularities, and thereafter lodged the complaint with the CBI. The gross irregular amount is ₹11,42,00,000 and the amount outstanding is ₹9,05,00,000.

CW-2 — Shri R. Subramanian (Concurrent Auditor)

Statement u/s 161 CrPC recorded on 22-Jan-2026

While auditing BO Ansal Plaza I found that 13 gold loan accounts each reflected a sanctioned limit without a corresponding jewellery receipt. The gold loan module showed 'pledge confirmed' flags for accounts having no entry in the physical strong-room register. I also noticed that disbursements in 9 cash credit accounts occurred at irregular hours, mostly between 18:00 and 21:00 hrs, on weekends. On cross-checking the CBS audit trail, the postings traced to the login credentials of the Branch Manager, Suresh Yadav, and Relationship Manager, Vipin Arora. I compiled my findings into the audit extract annexed to the complaint.

CW-4 — Shri S. Bhattacharya (DGM, CBS Administration)

Statement u/s 161 CrPC recorded on 05-Feb-2026

The CBS maintains a complete audit trail of user logins and transaction postings. For the period 01-Apr-2024 to 30-Nov-2025, loan limit entry and disbursement postings for the 22 accounts in question were made through user IDs UID-2123 (Suresh Yadav) and UID-2207 (Vipin Arora). I verified the timestamps, terminal IPs and digital signatures of these postings, which were mostly executed after business hours. The printouts of this audit trail have been certified by me under the bank's seal and handed over to the CBI.

CW-6 — Shri Vikas Thakur (IT Forensics Analyst, CBI)

Statement u/s 161 CrPC recorded on 18-Mar-2026

I analysed the KYC records, mobile numbers and transaction patterns of the 11 borrower accounts. The analysis established that (i) 11 accounts shared 3 common mobile numbers and a single email domain; (ii) disbursed funds were transferred in a circular fashion among these accounts over 20-day cycles; and (iii) the ultimate destination of 78% of the funds was accounts controlled by A-1. The clustering chart and fund-flow diagram form part of the evidence record. I also extracted deleted KYC images from the seized devices of A-3.

CW-7 — Shri Rajeev Tandon (Handwriting Expert)

Statement u/s 161 CrPC recorded on 25-Apr-2026

I examined the specimen signatures of the 11 borrowers against the signatures on the sanction memos and cash vouchers. I am of the opinion that the signatures of 9 of the 11 borrowers on the KYC and loan documents were written by the same hand — a single writer executed these documents. This supports the prosecution's case that the borrowers were fictitious or accommodated parties. My detailed report is annexed.

Recorded by:

Dy. SP Rahul Srivastava

CBI/BS&FC;

Witnesses:

CW-1, CW-2, CW-4, CW-6, CW-7

As deposed above